LARKSPUR & CO.

A GENTLE FIRST MONTH FOR YOU AND YOUR PUPPY

The 28-Day Puppy Plan

A day-by-day plan for your puppy's first four weeks: routines, toilet and crate training, socialisation, early training games and every tracker you need.

54 pages · Print at home · UK friendly



Every puppy is different. Go at your puppy's pace and ask your vet if you're unsure.

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START HERE

Welcome to puppy life

Bringing a puppy home is exciting, exhausting and a little overwhelming. This plan breaks the first month into small daily steps, so you always know what to focus on next.

HOW TO USE THIS PLAN

1. Work through the **getting ready** pages before your puppy arrives.
2. Each day has **one small focus**. Five minutes of practice, a few times a day, is plenty.
3. Use the **daily log** to track toilet trips, meals and naps. Patterns appear quickly.
4. Keep the **trackers** at the back for vet visits, weight and training.

GOOD TO KNOW

- [ ] Puppies sleep a lot, often 18 hours a day or more.
- [ ] Short training sessions work best: 1–3 minutes.
- [ ] Accidents are normal. Never punish them.
- [ ] Reward what you like, and gently redirect what you don't.
- [ ] Ask your vet about vaccinations, worming and when it's safe to go out.

This plan is general guidance for healthy puppies and isn't a substitute for advice from your vet or a qualified trainer. If you're worried about your puppy's health or behaviour, contact your vet.

NOTES

INSIDE

Contents

Getting ready

Puppy shopping list 4
Puppy-proofing your home 5
All about my puppy 6
The first 24 hours 7
A day in the life 8
Toilet training 9
Crate and bed training 10
Puppy biting 11
Socialisation 12
Socialisation checklists 13

The 28 days

Week 1: Settle in 15
Week 2: Build the routine 23
Week 3: Explore 31
Week 4: Grow in confidence 39

Trackers & records

Vaccinations, worming & vet visits 47
Weight tracker 48
Feeding plan 49
Training progress 50
Safety & emergencies 51
Puppy milestones 52
Puppy care sheet 53

GETTING READY

Puppy shopping list

Tick off what you have. You don't need everything on day one.

SLEEPING & RESTING

- [ ] Crate or puppy pen
- [ ] Comfy bed and washable blankets
- [ ] An old jumper that smells of you
- [ ] Baby gates for stairs or rooms

FOOD & WATER

- [ ] The same food your breeder or rescue used
- [ ] Food and water bowls
- [ ] Training treats (small and soft)
- [ ] A food-dispensing toy or lick mat

OUT & ABOUT

- [ ] Collar with an ID tag (your name and address)
- [ ] Lightweight lead
- [ ] Well-fitting puppy harness
- [ ] Poo bags and a dispenser

PLAY & CHEW

- [ ] Soft toys
- [ ] Puppy-safe chews
- [ ] A tug toy
- [ ] A ball or squeaky toy

CLEANING

- [ ] Enzyme cleaner for accidents
- [ ] Kitchen roll and old towels
- [ ] Puppy shampoo and a soft brush
- [ ] Puppy toothbrush and dog toothpaste

ADMIN

- [ ] Register with a vet
- [ ] Pet insurance
- [ ] Microchip details updated to your name
- [ ] Vaccination card from your breeder or rescue

In the UK, dogs must wear a collar and tag with the owner's name and address when in a public place, and must be microchipped with up-to-date details.

NOTES

GETTING READY

Puppy-proofing your home

Get down to puppy height and look around. Anything they can reach, they will chew.

LIVING ROOM

- [ ] Hide or cover cables and chargers
- [ ] Move shoes, remotes and small objects
- [ ] Check houseplants are safe for dogs
- [ ] Secure bins and bags

KITCHEN

- [ ] Chocolate, grapes, raisins and onions out of reach
- [ ] Sugar-free gum and sweets put away (xylitol is toxic)
- [ ] Child locks on low cupboards with cleaners
- [ ] Bin with a secure lid

GARDEN

- [ ] Check fences and gates for gaps
- [ ] Remove toxic plants and slug pellets
- [ ] Cover ponds
- [ ] Choose a toilet spot

EVERYWHERE

- [ ] Baby gates on stairs
- [ ] Medicines locked away
- [ ] Small toys tidied away
- [ ] Doors and windows kept closed

THINGS I STILL NEED TO SORT

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

NOTES

GETTING READY

All about my puppy

PUPPY

Name _____

Breed _____

Date of birth _____

Colour & markings _____

Came home on _____

Weight on arrival _____

MICROCHIP & ID

Microchip number _____

Database _____

Details updated? _____

ID tag ordered? _____

BREEDER OR RESCUE

Name _____

Phone _____

Food they were eating _____

Feeding times _____

VET & INSURANCE

Vet practice _____

Phone _____

Out-of-hours number _____

Insurance company _____

Policy number _____

NOTES

GETTING READY

The first 24 hours

Keep the first day calm and simple. Your puppy has just left everything they know.

1 **Arrival**
Take your puppy straight to their toilet spot first. Praise and reward if they go.

2 **Explore**
Let them explore one room with you. Keep visitors and excitement for another day.

3 **Food & water**
Offer a small meal of the food they're used to, and fresh water.

4 **Sleep**
Show them their bed or crate and let them nap as much as they like.

5 **Bedtime**
Many puppies settle better with their bed near you for the first nights. Take them out for a toilet trip last thing.

6 **Night**
Expect to get up in the night for toilet trips at first. Keep it quiet and boring, then straight back to bed.

MY NOTES FROM DAY ONE

GETTING READY

A day in the life

An example routine for a young puppy. Adjust it to fit your day, and follow your vet's and food's guidance on meals.

EXAMPLE ROUTINE

On waking	Straight outside to the toilet spot
Breakfast	Then a toilet trip
Play & training	5–10 minutes, then toilet
Nap	In the crate or bed
Lunch	Then a toilet trip
Gentle exploring	Then toilet and a nap
Afternoon meal	Then a toilet trip
Play & cuddles	Short and calm
Evening meal	Then a toilet trip
Wind down	A chew or lick mat
Last toilet trip	Then bed

MY PUPPY'S ROUTINE

TIME	WHAT

Toilet trips: take your puppy out after waking, after eating, after playing, and every hour or two while they're awake. Young puppies can't hold on for long.

NOTES

HOW TO

Toilet training

Toilet training takes weeks, not days. Consistency and rewards are what make it work.

Go out often

After waking, eating, playing and every hour or two. Stay with your puppy so you can reward them.

Same spot, same word

Use the same toilet spot and a calm cue like "be quick" while they go.

Reward straight away

Praise and give a treat the moment they finish, outside, not when they come back in.

Watch for signs

Sniffing, circling, whining or heading for the door usually means "I need to go".

Accidents happen

Never shout or punish. Calmly take them outside, and clean the spot with an enzyme cleaner so it doesn't smell like a toilet.

Night-time

Keep night trips quiet and boring. Most puppies gradually manage longer at night as they grow.

WHAT'S WORKING FOR US

HOW TO

Crate and bed training

A crate or pen can be a safe, cosy den, as long as it's always a happy place.

Make it lovely

Soft bedding, a chew, a blanket over the top for a den feel. Leave the door open at first.

Meals in the crate

Feeding meals in or near the crate builds a happy link.

Short and sweet

Close the door for a few seconds while they eat or chew, then open it. Build up slowly.

Never a punishment

The crate should only ever mean good things, never time out.

Sleep and rest

Puppies need lots of sleep. A quiet den helps them switch off.

Not too long

Puppies shouldn't be shut in for long periods. Plan toilet breaks, company and play.

CRATE PROGRESS

DATE	DOOR CLOSED FOR	HOW IT WENT

NOTES

HOW TO

Puppy biting and mouthing

Mouthing is normal puppy behaviour. Your job is to teach gentle mouths and offer better things to chew.

It's normal

Puppies explore with their mouths, and teething makes it worse. It usually eases as they grow.

Redirect

Keep a toy in your hand or pocket and offer it when teeth come out.

Pause the game

If teeth touch skin, calmly stop playing for a moment, then start again with a toy.

Tired puppies bite more

Overtired puppies get nippy. A nap often works better than more play.

Chew menu

Offer a few different safe chews and see which your puppy loves.

Children

Supervise children and puppies together, and teach children to stand still and fold their arms if the puppy gets mouthy.

OUR BEST BITING FIXES

HOW TO

Socialisation

Puppies are most open to new experiences in their first few months. Calm, positive introductions now help your puppy become a confident adult dog.

THE GOLDEN RULES

- [ ] Short and positive every time
- [ ] Let your puppy watch from a distance first
- [ ] Pair new things with treats
- [ ] Never force them to go closer
- [ ] If they seem worried, move further away
- [ ] Quality matters more than quantity

BEFORE VACCINATIONS ARE FINISHED

Ask your vet when it's safe for your puppy to walk in public places and meet other dogs. Until then, you can still socialise safely:

- [ ] Carry your puppy to see the world
- [ ] Invite calm visitors to your home
- [ ] Explore your own enclosed garden
- [ ] Play recordings of everyday sounds
- [ ] Meet dogs you know are fully vaccinated (if your vet agrees)

SIGNS YOUR PUPPY NEEDS A BREAK

Tucked tail, ears back, lip licking, yawning, turning away, freezing, trying to hide. If you see these, calmly move away and try again another day, from further away.

NOTES

SOCIALISATION

Socialisation checklist (1 of 2)

Tick each time your puppy has a calm, happy experience.

PEOPLE

EXPERIENCE	1ST	2ND	3RD	HOW IT WENT
Men				
Women				
Children (supervised)				
People in hats or sunglasses				
People with beards				
People in high-vis or uniforms				
People with walking sticks, wheelchairs or pushchairs				

SOUNDS

EXPERIENCE	1ST	2ND	3RD	HOW IT WENT
Doorbell and knocking				
Hoover and washing machine				
Traffic and buses				
Fireworks (recording, quietly)				
Thunder (recording, quietly)				
Babies crying				
TV and music				

NOTES

SOCIALISATION

Socialisation checklist (2 of 2)

Keep going after the first month. Socialisation is a lifelong habit.

PLACES & SURFACES

EXPERIENCE	1ST	2ND	3RD	HOW IT WENT
The car				
Grass, gravel and mud				
Wet ground and puddles				
Stairs and slippery floors				
A café or pub garden				
The vet practice (happy visit)				

HANDLING

EXPERIENCE	1ST	2ND	3RD	HOW IT WENT
Paws and nails				
Ears and eyes				
Mouth and teeth				
Brushing				
Wearing a harness				
Being lifted gently				

ANIMALS

EXPERIENCE	1ST	2ND	3RD	HOW IT WENT
Calm vaccinated adult dog				
Cats (at a distance)				
Horses or farm animals (at a distance)				
Birds and wildlife				

WEEK 1 OF 4

Settle in

Everything is new. This week is about comfort, sleep, a simple routine and lots of gentle getting-to-know-you.

THIS WEEK

- [ ] Day 1: A calm first day
- [ ] Day 2: The name game
- [ ] Day 3: A cosy crate or den
- [ ] Day 4: Toilet routine
- [ ] Day 5: Gentle handling
- [ ] Day 6: Hand feeding
- [ ] Day 7: Rest and review

MY HOPES FOR THE FIRST WEEK

DAY
1

WEEK 1 · SETTLE IN
A calm first day

Date _____

Today's focus
Keep today quiet. Show your puppy their bed, water and toilet spot, then let them explore one room at a time. Lots of sleep is normal.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
2

WEEK 1 · SETTLE IN

The name game

Date _____

Today's focus

Say your puppy's name once in a happy voice. The moment they look at you, give a tiny treat. Repeat 5–10 times, a few times a day.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

DAY
3

WEEK 1 · SETTLE IN
A cosy crate or den

Date _____

Today's focus
Make the crate or bed the best place in the house: soft bedding, a chew, meals served there with the door open. Never use it as a punishment.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
4

WEEK 1 · SETTLE IN
Toilet routine

Date _____

Today's focus
Take your puppy to the same spot after waking, eating, playing and every hour or two. Say a cue like "be quick", then praise and reward the moment they go.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
5

WEEK 1 · SETTLE IN
Gentle handling

Date _____

Today's focus
Touch paws, ears and mouth for a second at a time, then give a treat. This makes vet visits, grooming and nail trims much easier later.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
6

WEEK 1 · SETTLE IN
Hand feeding

Date _____

Today's focus
Feed part of a meal from your hand, one piece at a time. It builds trust and teaches your puppy that hands bring good things.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
7

WEEK 1 · SETTLE IN
Rest and review

Date _____

Today's focus
A lighter day. Notice what's going well, fill in your week 1 review, and enjoy some quiet cuddles.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

WEEK 2 OF 4

Build the routine

Your puppy is finding their feet. Keep the routine steady and start a few short, fun training games.

THIS WEEK

- [ ] Day 8: Sit
- [ ] Day 9: Short alone times
- [ ] Day 10: Chew time
- [ ] Day 11: Collar and lead indoors
- [ ] Day 12: New sounds
- [ ] Day 13: Calm visitors
- [ ] Day 14: Rest and review

WEEK 1 REVIEW: WHAT WENT WELL

DAY
8

WEEK 2 · BUILD THE ROUTINE
Sit

Date _____

Today's focus
Hold a treat by your puppy's nose and move it slowly up and back. As their bottom goes down, say "yes" and reward. Practise for a minute at a time.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
9

WEEK 2 · BUILD THE ROUTINE

Short alone times

Date _____

Today's focus

Leave the room for a few seconds while your puppy has a chew, then come back calmly. Build up very slowly so being alone feels normal.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
10

WEEK 2 · BUILD THE ROUTINE
Chew time

Date _____

Today's focus
Puppies need to chew, especially while teething. Offer suitable chews and swap anything they shouldn't have for something they can.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
11

WEEK 2 · BUILD THE ROUTINE

Collar and lead indoors

Date _____

Today's focus

Let your puppy wear their collar for short spells, then clip on the lead indoors and follow them around with treats. No pulling, just getting used to it.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
12

WEEK 2 · BUILD THE ROUTINE

New sounds

Date _____

Today's focus

Play everyday sounds (traffic, doorbells, hoovers, fireworks) very quietly while your puppy eats or plays. Only turn it up if they stay relaxed.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
13

WEEK 2 · BUILD THE ROUTINE

Calm visitors

Date _____

Today's focus

Invite one calm visitor. Ask them to let your puppy come to them, crouch down, and offer a treat. Keep it short and happy.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
14

WEEK 2 · BUILD THE ROUTINE

Rest and review

Date _____

Today's focus

A lighter day with a sniffy play session and plenty of naps. Fill in your week 2 review.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

WEEK 3 OF 4

Explore

New sounds, surfaces and gentle handling. Keep every experience short, positive and at your puppy's pace.

THIS WEEK

- [ ] Day 15: Come when called
- [ ] Day 16: Down
- [ ] Day 17: A short car trip
- [ ] Day 18: Surfaces and textures
- [ ] Day 19: First brush
- [ ] Day 20: Leave it
- [ ] Day 21: Rest and review

WEEK 2 REVIEW: WHAT WENT WELL

DAY
15

WEEK 3 · EXPLORE

Come when called

Date _____

Today's focus

In the house, say your puppy's name and "come" in a happy voice, then reward with a treat and a fuss when they reach you. Keep it a fun game.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
16

WEEK 3 · EXPLORE
Down

Date _____

Today's focus
From a sit, lower a treat slowly to the floor between their paws. When their elbows touch down, say "yes" and reward.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

DAY
17

WEEK 3 · EXPLORE
A short car trip

Date _____

Today's focus
Sit in the parked car together with a treat or chew. If that goes well, try a very short drive. Keep your puppy safely secured.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
18

WEEK 3 · EXPLORE

Surfaces and textures

Date _____

Today's focus

Let your puppy explore different surfaces at home: a doormat, a towel, foil, a cushion, a tray. Reward curiosity and never force them.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
19

WEEK 3 · EXPLORE
First brush

Date _____

Today's focus
Use a soft brush for a few strokes, then a treat. Keep it short. Check ears, eyes and teeth at the same time.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

DAY
20

WEEK 3 · EXPLORE
Leave it

Date _____

Today's focus
Show a treat in your closed hand. When your puppy stops trying to get it and moves away, say "yes" and give a different treat from the other hand.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
21

WEEK 3 · EXPLORE
Rest and review

Date _____

Today's focus
Halfway past the first month! Have a calm day and fill in your week 3 review.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

WEEK 4 OF 4

Grow in confidence

Calm settling, early lead skills and planning what comes next, including puppy classes.

THIS WEEK

- [ ] Day 22: Settle on a mat
- [ ] Day 23: Loose lead basics
- [ ] Day 24: A calm dog friend
- [ ] Day 25: Wait at doors
- [ ] Day 26: A happy vet visit
- [ ] Day 27: Puppy classes
- [ ] Day 28: Celebrate!

WEEK 3 REVIEW: WHAT WENT WELL

DAY
22

WEEK 4 · GROW IN CONFIDENCE
Settle on a mat

Date _____

Today's focus
Put a mat down and reward your puppy for any calm behaviour on it: lying down, sighing, relaxing. This helps them switch off.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
23

WEEK 4 · GROW IN CONFIDENCE

Loose lead basics

Date _____

Today's focus

In the house or garden, reward your puppy every time they're next to you with a loose lead. A few steps at a time is plenty.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
24

WEEK 4 · GROW IN CONFIDENCE
A calm dog friend

Date _____

Today's focus
If your vet says it's safe, let your puppy meet one calm, friendly, fully vaccinated adult dog. Keep it short and let them choose how close to go.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

DAY
25

WEEK 4 · GROW IN CONFIDENCE
Wait at doors

Date _____

Today's focus
Before opening a door, wait for your puppy to pause for a second, then say "OK" and go through together. This builds patience and keeps them safe.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
26

WEEK 4 · GROW IN CONFIDENCE
A happy vet visit

Date _____

Today's focus
Pop into the vet practice just to say hello, have a treat and leave. Many practices are happy to help puppies get used to the building.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

DAY
27

WEEK 4 · GROW IN CONFIDENCE

Puppy classes

Date _____

Today's focus

Look for a reward-based puppy class near you. Write down a few options and book one that suits your puppy and your timetable.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE

What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NOTES

DAY
28

WEEK 4 · GROW IN CONFIDENCE
Celebrate!

Date _____

Today's focus
You made it through the first month. Look back at day 1, fill in the milestones page and plan the next month together.

TOILET LOG

TIME	WEE	POO	OUTSIDE?

MEALS

TIME	FOOD & AMOUNT

NAPS

_____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____

TRAINING PRACTICE
What we practised and how many goes:

NEW EXPERIENCES

TODAY'S WINS

Puppy's mood ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

My energy ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

NOTES

RECORDS

Vaccinations, worming & vet visits

Ask your vet for a vaccination and parasite plan, and record each one here.

DATE	TYPE	PRODUCT / VACCINE	NEXT DUE	NOTES

RECORDS

Weight tracker

Weigh your puppy regularly (your vet practice can help). Steady growth is what matters.

DATE	AGE	WEIGHT	NOTES

RECORDS

Feeding plan

Follow the guidance on your puppy's food or from your vet. Puppies usually need several small meals a day.

CURRENT PLAN

Food _____ Daily amount _____

Meals per day _____ Treat allowance _____

DATE	CHANGE	WHY	HOW IT WENT

RECORDS

Training progress

Colour in each box as your puppy gets more confident with each skill.

SKILL	LEARNING	GETTING IT	GOT IT AT HOME	GOT IT OUTSIDE
Name game				
Sit				
Down				
Come				
Leave it				
Wait				
Settle on a mat				
Loose lead				
Crate / bed				
Handling				
Calm greetings				

NOTES

KEEP THIS HANDY

Safety & emergencies

If your puppy eats something they shouldn't, or seems unwell, call your vet straight away, even if they seem fine.

TOXIC TO DOGS

- [ ] Chocolate
- [ ] Grapes, raisins, currants and sultanas
- [ ] Onions, garlic, leeks and chives
- [ ] Xylitol (in sugar-free gum, sweets and some peanut butters)
- [ ] Macadamia nuts
- [ ] Alcohol and caffeine
- [ ] Cooked bones
- [ ] Human medicines such as ibuprofen

CALL THE VET IF YOU NOTICE

- [ ] Vomiting or diarrhoea that doesn't settle
- [ ] Not eating or drinking
- [ ] Lethargy or collapse
- [ ] Breathing difficulties
- [ ] Swelling or a sore belly
- [ ] Any injury or bleeding
- [ ] Seizures
- [ ] Anything that worries you

EMERGENCY NUMBERS

My vet _____

Out-of-hours vet _____

Insurance claims line _____

Emergency contact _____

NOTES

MEMORIES

Puppy milestones

Write down the firsts. You'll love looking back on these.

FIRST NIGHT HOME

Date _____

FIRST "SIT"

Date _____

FIRST WALK OUTSIDE

Date _____

FIRST PUPPY CLASS

Date _____

FAVOURITE TOY

Date _____

FUNNIEST MOMENT

Date _____

BEST NAP SPOT

Date _____

NICKNAMES

Date _____

PHOTO OR DRAWING

FOR SITTERS & FAMILY

Puppy care sheet

Fill this in for anyone looking after your puppy.

PUPPY

Name _____

Age _____

Microchip _____

FOOD

Food & amount _____

Meal times _____

Treats allowed _____

ROUTINE

Toilet cue & spot _____

Nap times _____

Bedtime routine _____

TRAINING

Cues they know _____

House rules _____

Things to avoid _____

HEALTH

Medicines _____

Allergies _____

Vet & phone _____

CONTACTS

My mobile _____

Back-up contact _____

Insurance _____

NOTES

THANK YOU

Here's to many happy years

Thank you for choosing Larkspur & Co. If this plan helped your first month together, a short Etsy review would mean the world to a small Glasgow business.

NEXT MONTH, WE'LL WORK ON...